European Commission



FLASH EUROBAROMETER 564

Future needs in digital education

EUROBAROMETER **SUMMARY**
MAY 2025

ON-LINE EUROBAROMETER

Survey conducted by Ipsos European Public Affairs at the request of the European Commission, Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture

Survey coordinated by the European Commission, Directorate-General for Communication (DG COMM "Public Opinion and Citizens Engagement" Unit)

This document does not represent the point of view of the European Commission. The interpretations and opinions contained in it are solely those of the authors.

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Introduction

This Flash Eurobarometer provides an overview of European citizens' attitudes towards digital education. It examines attitudes towards key themes, such as:

- The perceived importance of digital skills, barriers to digital skills development and digital skills education;
- Digital technologies in education, their impact and the balance between digital and traditional learning.
- Perspectives about AI in education, ensuring appropriate use of AI in education, and the future importance of AI literacy.
- Responsible use of digital technologies, and teachers' and parents' roles in facilitating responsible use.
- Awareness of personal data collection in digital learning and concerns about digital education data risks.
- EU support for digital education.

On behalf of the European Commission's Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture, Ipsos European Public Affairs interviewed a representative sample of EU citizens, aged 15 and over, in each of the 27 Member States of the European Union. Between 7 and 14 May 2025, 25 781 interviews were conducted via computer-assisted web interviewing (CAWI), using Ipsos' online panels and their partner network.

Notes

- Survey data are weighted to marginal age by gender population distributions using post-stratification weighting. The EU27 are weighted according to the size of the 15+ population of each region/ country.
- Response percentages exceed 100% if the question allowed respondents to select multiple responses.
- In this report, countries are referred to by their official abbreviation, as indicated below.

BE	Belgium	FR	France	NL	Netherlands
BG	Bulgaria	HR	Croatia	AT	Austria
CZ	Czechia	IT	Italy	PL	Poland
DK	Denmark	CY	Rep. of Cyprus*	PT	Portugal
DE	Germany	LV	Latvia	RO	Romania
EE	Estonia	LT	Lithuania	SI	Slovenia
IE	Ireland	LU	Luxembourg	SK	Slovakia
EL	Greece	HU	Hungary	FI	Finland
ES	Spain	MT	Malta	SE	Sweden

* Cyprus as a whole is one of the 27 EU Member States. For practical reasons, interviews are only carried out in the part of the country controlled by the government of the Republic of Cyprus.

1. Digital skills and the role of education

1.1. Perceptions of digital skills

About nine in ten respondents (89%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **digital skills are essential for participation in society** (for example for banking, healthcare, community engagement, etc.). Similarly, 80% of respondents agree that **digital skills are essential to have a successful career**.

More than eight in ten respondents (86%) agree that **expanding digital skills training is important to improve the economy of their countries**.

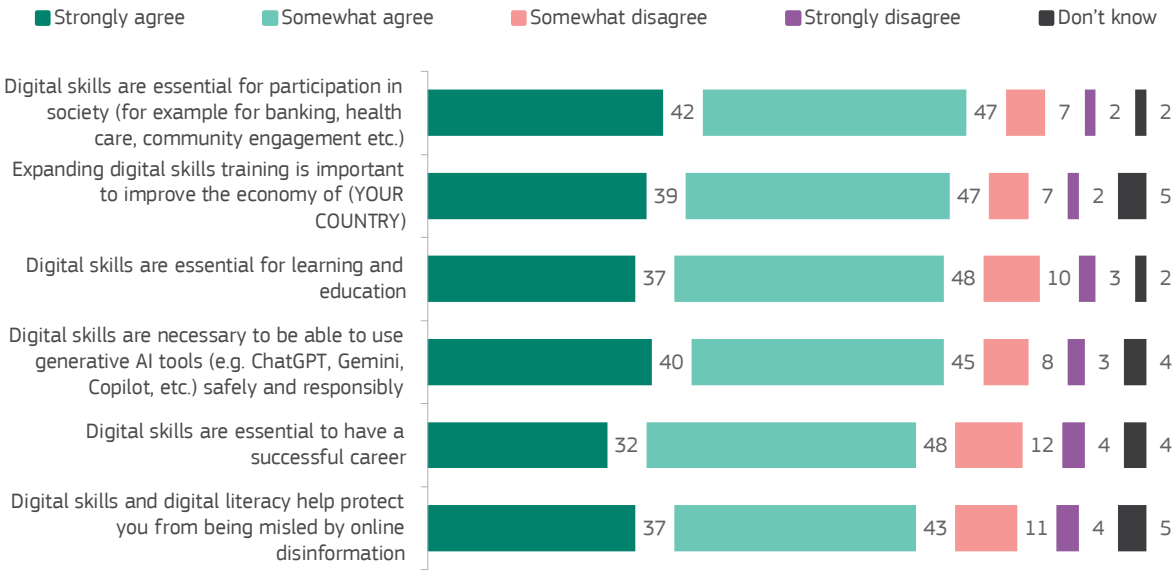
Eighty-five percent of respondents agree that **digital skills are essential for learning and education**.

Eight in ten respondents (80%) agree that **digital skills and digital literacy help protect them from being misled by online disinformation**. Similarly, 85% of respondents agree that **digital skills are necessary to be able to use generative AI tools** (e.g. ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot, etc.) **safely and responsibly**.

Individual country results

There is widespread agreement with these statements across the Member States. For example, in each of the EU27 Member States, more than four in five respondents, in total, agree that digital skills are essential for participation in society. Respondents in Malta (96%) and Finland (96%) are the most likely to agree with this statement; those in from France (85%) and Germany (85%) are the least likely to agree.

Q1 And to what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

1.2. Digital skills education

Just over nine in ten respondents (92%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **digital skills should be taught to everyone in schools and universities.** The share agreeing is over three-quarters for the remaining two statements: **digital skills should receive the same amount of attention at school as reading, mathematics and science** (78%) and **the teaching of digital skills should start at an early age** (76%)

Individual country results

In each of the Member States, more than eight in ten respondents, in total, agree that digital skills should be taught to everyone in schools and universities (from 86% in Sweden to 98% in Cyprus). Some more variation across the Member States is seen for the statement that digital skills should receive the same amount of attention at school as reading, mathematics and science (with the share agreeing ranging from 66% in Luxembourg to 90% in Romania) and for the statement that the teaching of digital skills should start at an early age (from 61% in Slovenia to 84% in Malta).

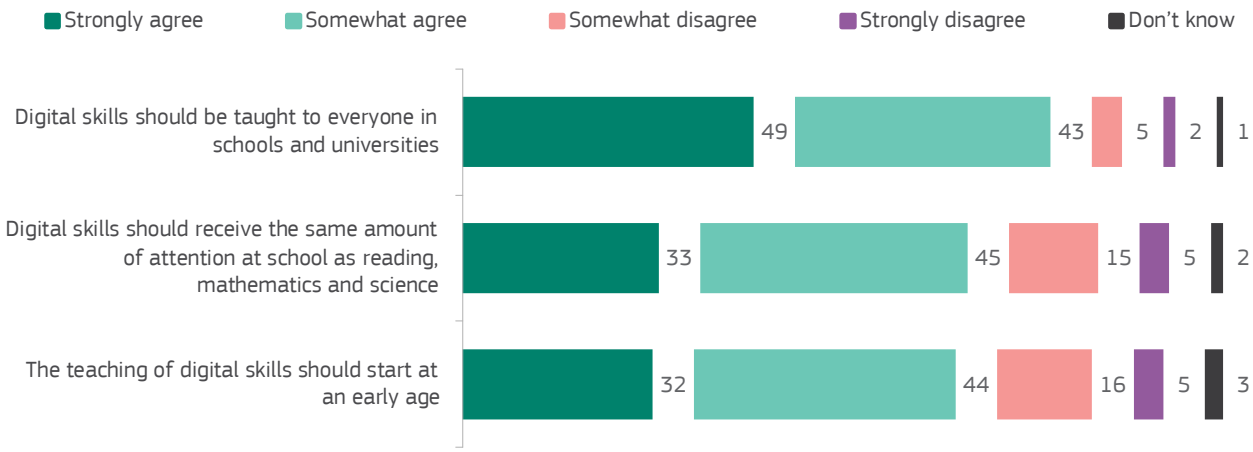
1.3. Barriers to digital skills development

Respondents were informed that recent statistics show 44% of 13-14 year-olds in the EU lack basic digital skills. They were then asked to identify the **most important reasons, in their opinion, preventing this age group from developing these skills**.

Nearly one in two respondents (47%) believe that this is because **the schools are not well-equipped** (e.g. they do not have enough computers/tablets, or the internet connection at school is very slow). About four in ten respondents (41%) report as a main reason that **teachers are not adequately prepared to teach digital skills**.

Each of the following reasons are mentioned by over a third of respondents: **parents or guardians are not knowledgeable enough to teach digital skills at home** (38%), **families cannot afford the equipment needed to practice digital skills** (e.g. computers/tablets) (37%) and **school programmes do not devote enough attention to digital skills** (35%). Just over one in ten respondents (13%) consider as a main reason the fact that **students are not motivated to learn digital skills**

Q3 To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

2. Digital technologies in education

2.1. Impact of digital technologies on education

Vast majorities of respondents 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **digital technologies can be used to provide students access to tailored learning to meet their individual needs** (87%), and that **digital technologies can make education and training more innovative** (87%).

More than eight in ten respondents agree with the statements that **online learning can benefit lifelong learning by providing continuous access to education and training** (85%); similar shares agree that **digital technologies can break down barriers to learning for people with disabilities** (84%) and that **digital technologies can make education and training more accessible and inclusive** (83%).

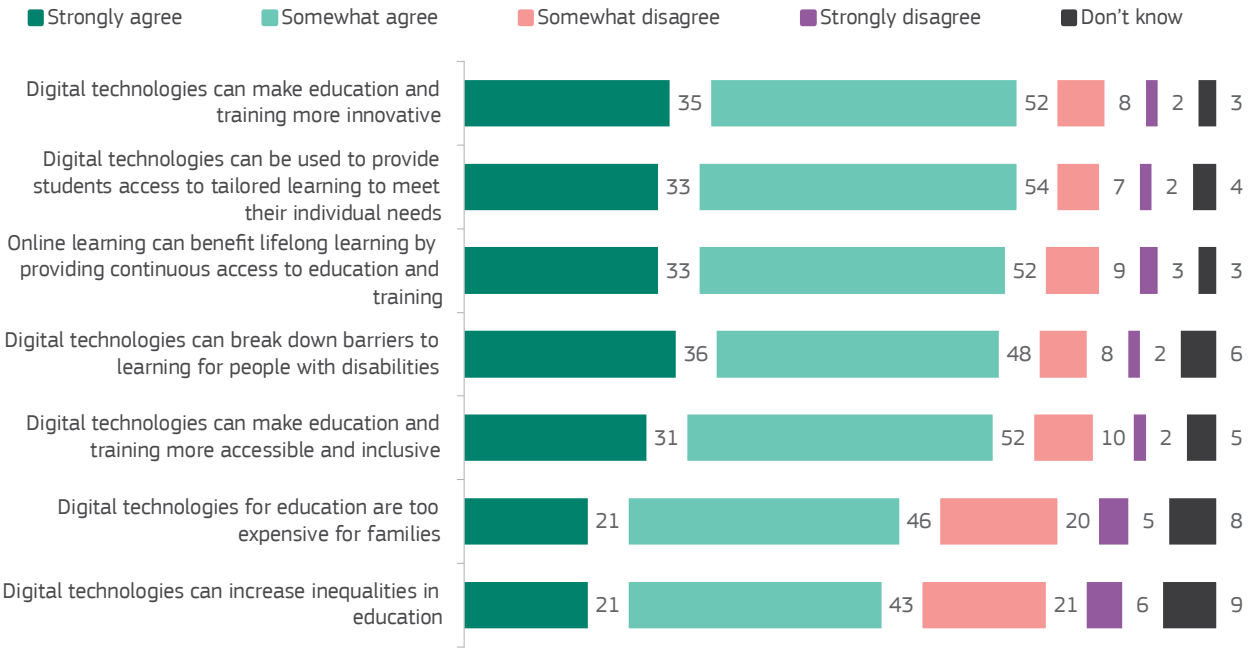
Around two-thirds of respondents agree that **digital technologies for education are too expensive for families** (67%). More than six in ten respondents agree that **digital technologies can increase inequalities in education** (64%).

Individual country results

For most statements, a vast majority of respondents across all Member States express agreement. For example, across all Member States, a minimum of about eight in ten respondents agree with the view that digital technologies can make education and training more innovative (from 79% in Denmark to 94% in Ireland, Cyprus and Portugal).

Agreement is lower regarding the statement that digital technologies for education are too expensive for families (from 55% in Estonia to 83% in Portugal and Romania) and that digital technologies can increase inequalities in education (from 52% in Estonia to 74% in France).

Q4 To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

2.2. Balancing digital and traditional learning

More than eight in ten respondents (87%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **digital technologies specifically designed for learning should be promoted in schools**.

About seven in ten respondents (69%) that **personal digital devices, such as smartphones, should be banned from schools**.

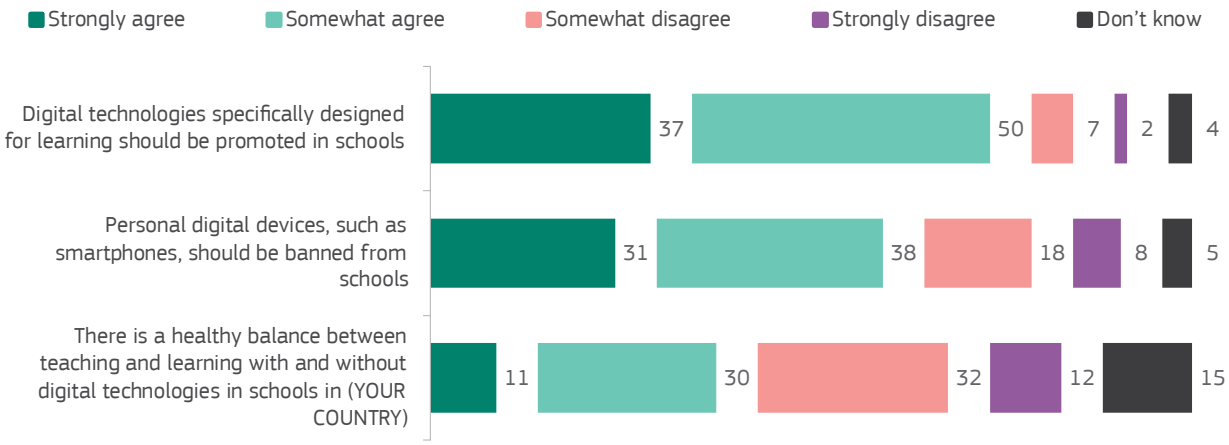
Regarding whether **there is a healthy balance between teaching and learning with and without digital technologies in schools in their countries**, opinions are almost equally split, with 41% agreeing and 44% disagreeing.

Individual country results

The share of respondents agreeing that digital technologies specifically designed for learning should be promoted in schools is highest in Portugal (95%), Cyprus (93%), Romania (92%) and Slovakia (92%) and lowest in Belgium (79%), Denmark (80%), Sweden (80%). More variation in the level of agreement is seen for the statement that personal digital devices, such as smartphones, should be banned from schools – from 39% in Hungary to 80% in France.

In seven Member States, at least half of agree that there is a healthy balance between teaching and learning with and without digital technologies in schools in their countries: Ireland (65%), Denmark (62%), Bulgaria (61%), Romania (58%), Portugal (52%), Lithuania (51%) and Finland (50%). In all other Member States, however, less than half of respondents agree – from 27% in Cyprus to 49% in Malta.

Q5 And to what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

3. Perspectives about AI in education

3.1. Future importance of AI literacy

More than six in ten respondents (63%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that, **in 2030, everyone will need to be AI-literate** (know how to use and work with AI).

Individual country results

In all but one Member State, a majority of respondents agree that, in 2030, everyone will need to be AI-literate (from 52% in Estonia to 76% in Romania). The only exception where agreement does not reach a majority is Czechia, where 49% agree and 41% disagree.

3.2. Position about AI in education

When asked about their position on the use of AI in education, perceptions are mixed. More than half (54%) believe that **AI can both benefit and bring risks to teaching and learning, and that the education community should assess and explore both**. Nearly one in four respondents (22%) think that **AI does not belong in the classroom**.

In contrast, about one in six (17%) state that **AI can improve teaching and learning, and that the education community should not be afraid to experiment with it**.

Individual country results

In most Member States, more than half of respondents believe that AI can both benefit and bring risks to teaching and learning, and that the education community should assess and explore both. Nearly two-thirds of respondents share this view in Finland (65%). The share selecting this response is lowest in Ireland (43%).

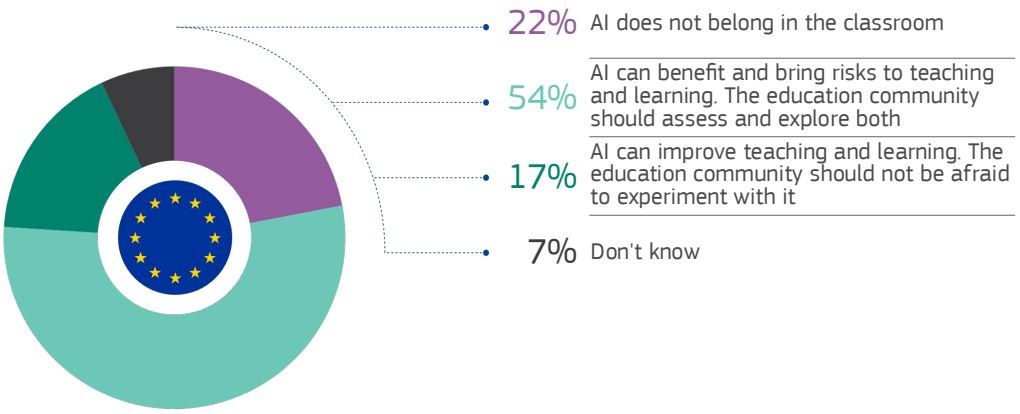
3.3. Teachers and AI proficiency

About eight in ten respondents (81%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **all teachers should be equipped with the skills to use and understand AI, including generative AI**.

Individual country results

Agreement that all teachers should be equipped with the skills to use and understand AI, including generative AI, reaches its peak in Cyprus, where about nine in ten respondents (91%) support this view. In contrast, about three-quarters of respondents in Czechia (74%), Hungary (75%), the Netherlands (75%), Estonia (76%) and Belgium (76%) agree with this statement.

Q6 What is your position on the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in education?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

3.4. Ensuring appropriate use of AI in education

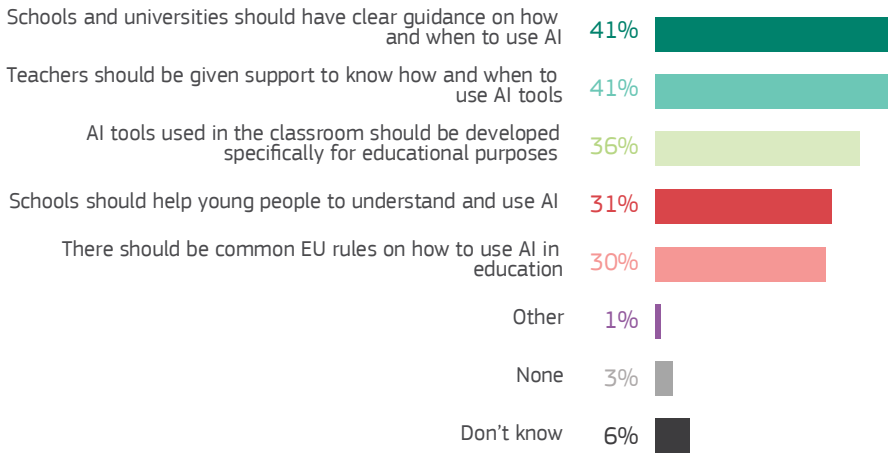
Respondents were asked what, in their view, would be necessary to ensure that AI (including generative AI) is used appropriately in education.

The two most frequently mentioned necessities, each cited by about four in ten respondents (41%), are that **schools and universities should have clear guidance on how and when to use AI**, and that **teachers should be given support to know how and when to use AI tools**.

Over a third of respondents (36%) believe that **AI tools used in the classroom should be developed specifically for educational purposes**.

Slightly less common responses are the view that **schools should help young people to understand and use AI** (31%) and that **there should be common EU rules on how to use AI in education** (30%).

Q7 In your view, what is necessary to ensure that AI (including generative AI) is used in education appropriately? [MULTIPLE ANSWERS]



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

4. Responsible use of digital technologies

This chapter explores views on the roles of teachers, schools and parents in promoting digital safety and combatting online disinformation.

4.1. Teachers' role in digital safety

About nine in ten respondents (89%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **all teachers should be equipped with the skills to help students in recognising various forms of disinformation online** (i.e. fake online content, AI-generated false text/videos/images).

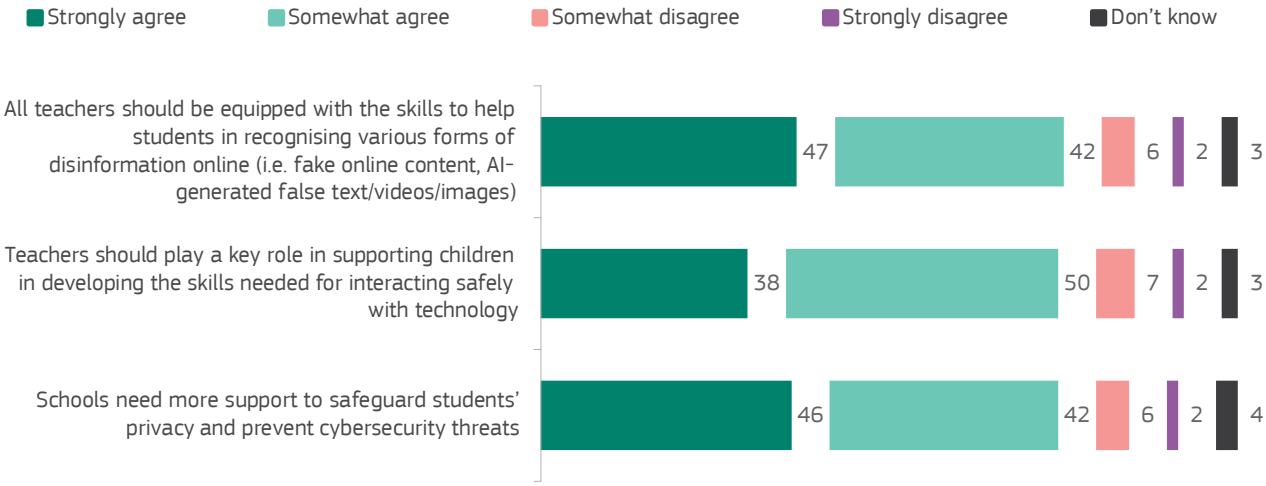
Similarly, just under nine in ten respondents (88%) agree that **teachers should play a key role in supporting children in developing the skills needed for interacting safely with technology**.

The same proportion (88%) of respondents agree that **schools need more support to safeguard students' privacy and prevent cybersecurity threats**.

Individual country results

There is a consensus across the Member States that teachers have a role to play in digital safety. For example, at least 85% of respondents in each Member State agree that all teachers should be equipped with the skills to help students in recognising various forms of disinformation online. The proportion agreeing with this statement varies between 85% in Belgium, France and the Netherlands, and 95% in Portugal.

Q9 To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

4.2. Parents' role in digital safety

More than eight in ten respondents (87%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **parents and families have a crucial role in teaching their children how to use technology safely and responsibly**.

Eighty-seven percent of respondents agree that **parents should be given guidance on how to support their children in developing the skills needed for interacting safely with technology**.

Individual country results

Vast majorities, no less than 80% in each Member State, agree that parents and families have a crucial role in teaching their children how to use technology safely and responsibly, with the proportion agreeing ranging from 82% in France to 95% in Malta.

Similarly, more than eight in ten respondents in all Member States agree that parents should be given guidance on how to support their children in developing the skills needed for interacting safely with technology. Agreement is highest in Malta (96%) and Cyprus (95%), and lowest in Czechia (80%).

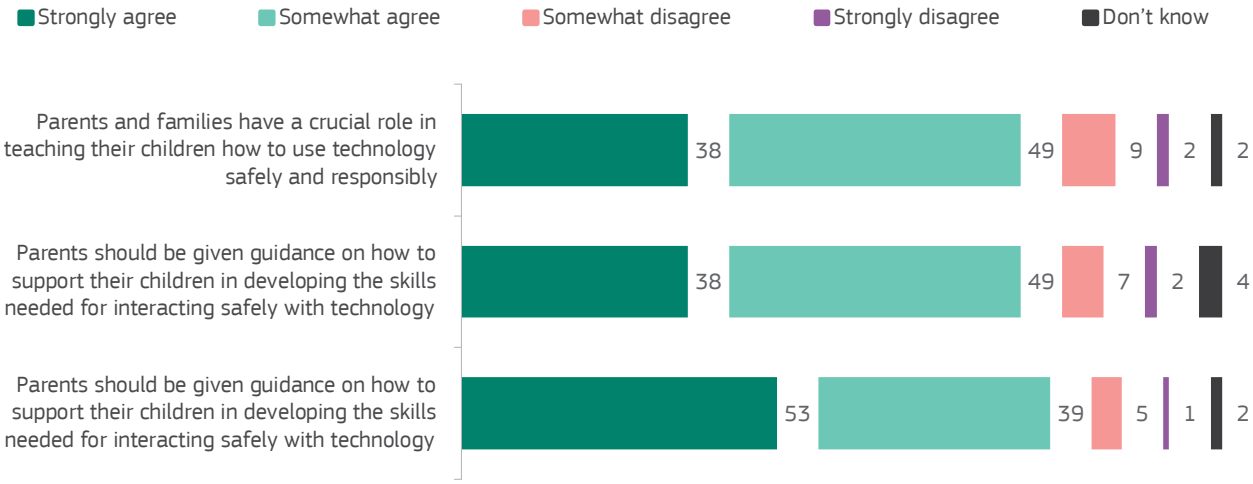
4.3. Digital skills and the impact on health

Over nine in ten respondents (92%) 'strongly' or 'somewhat' agree that **schools should teach young people how to manage the impact of digital technologies, such as social media, on their mental and physical health.**

Individual country results

Consistently high levels of agreement are observed across the Member States with the view that schools should teach young people how to manage the impact of digital technologies, such as social media, on their mental and physical health. The proportion agreeing ranging from nearly nine in ten (89%) in Belgium and France, to almost all in Cyprus (97%) and Portugal (97%).

Q3/Q5/Q9 To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statements?



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

5. Awareness and concerns of personal data handling in digital learning

5.1. Awareness of personal data collection in digital learning

More than six in ten respondents report to be 'fully aware' (14%) or 'somewhat aware' (48%) of the type of personal data being collected when using digital learning tools.[1] On the other hand, about three in ten are 'somewhat unaware' (24%) or 'fully unaware' (7%).

Individual country results

Respondents in Romania (86%) are overall the most likely to report being aware of the type of personal data being collected when using digital learning tools. Romania is followed by France (73%), Portugal (73%), Bulgaria (71%) and Slovakia (71%). In contrast, more than half of respondents in Slovenia (59%) feel unaware of the type of personal data collection in digital learning.

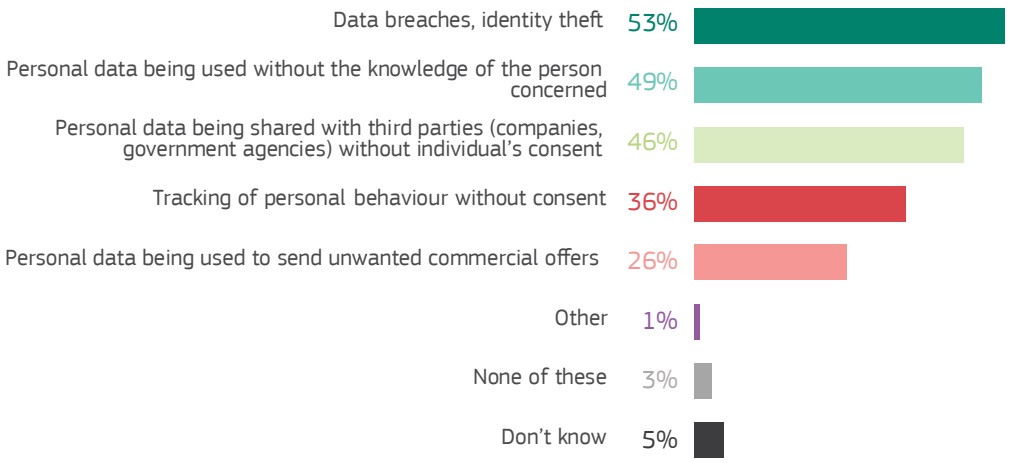
5.2. Concerns about digital education data risks

Respondents were asked whether they were, or would be, concerned about certain risks related to the use of digital tools for education or learning.

Just over half of respondents (53%) report concerns about data breaches and identity theft, and about half (49%) mention **concerns about personal data being used without the knowledge of the person concerned**. Over four in ten indicate (46%) being concerned about **personal data being shared with third parties** (companies, government agencies) **without individual's consent**.

Over a third (36%) mention concerns about tracking of personal behaviour without consent. About one in four (26%) report concerns about personal data being used to send unwanted commercial offers.

Q11 Are you (or would you be) concerned about any of the following risks related to the use of digital tools for education or learning? [MULTIPLE ANSWERS]



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents

[1] Respondents who indicated that they do not use digital learning tools are excluded from the analysis presented in this section.

6. EU support for digital education

Finally, respondents were asked about **how the EU could best support successful digital education across EU Member States.**

About one in two respondents (49%) recommend **developing EU standards for the use of digital technology in education, for example on data privacy or in using artificial intelligence in education**.

More than a third of respondents think the EU can support successful education by **providing funding for equipment and infrastructure, including internet connections** (36%); a similar figure is seen for **offering opportunities to help people improve their digital skills** (35%).

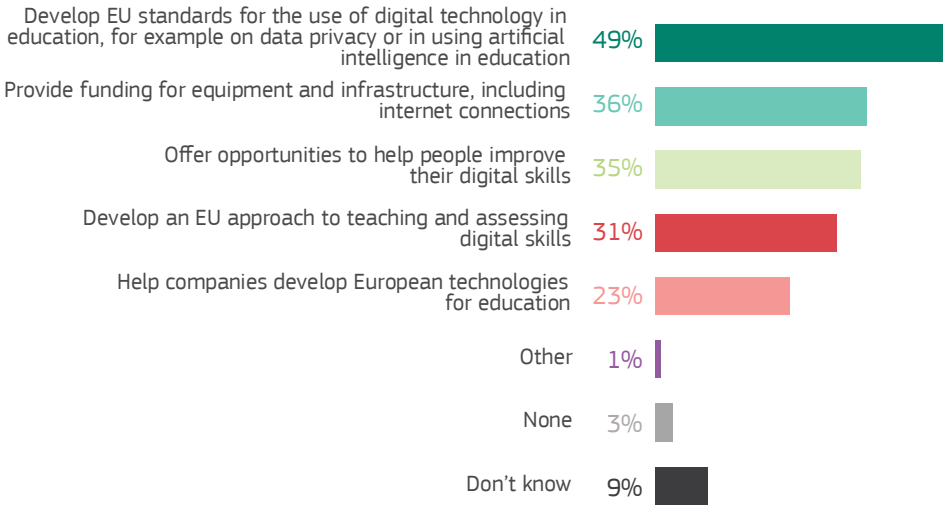
About three in ten respondents (31%) think the EU should develop an EU approach to teaching and assessing digital skills. Nearly one in four (23%) suggest helping companies develop European technologies for education.

Individual country results

In 21 Member States, the top-ranking recommendation for EU support in digital education is to develop EU standards for the use of digital technology in education, for example on data privacy or in using artificial intelligence in education. The share selecting this response is highest in Malta (62%), Portugal (60%), Ireland (57%) and Spain (57%).

In four Member States – Croatia (58%), Hungary (48%), Slovakia (44%) and Czechia (39%) – respondents most commonly recommend that the EU support digital education by providing funding for equipment and infrastructure, including internet connections. In contrast, just under one in four respondents in Sweden (23%) and Denmark (24%) recommend this support measure.

Q12 In your opinion, how can the EU best support successful digital education across EU Member States? [MULTIPLE ANSWERS]



(%) Base: n=25 781 – All respondents



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